

ECON 2Y03 C01: Intermediate Macroeconomics I

Spring 2026

Instructor Information

Instructor Name: Rizwan Tahir

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Office hours: Posted on Avenue to Learn (A2L)

Course Information

Lectures: The course has no in-person lectures but has **in-person final exam**.

Labs: No

Tutorials: No

Course Dates: 2026/05/04- 2026/06/19

Units: 3.0

Course Delivery Mode: Online

Course Description: This course uses macroeconomic theory based on microeconomic underpinnings to study key topics, including consumption-savings decisions, labour demand and labour supply decisions, investment in physical capital and business cycles.

Meeting Details

The course contents are **delivered online**. Weekly modules are designed based on each chapter of the textbook. Each module includes lecture slides, lecture video, and MyLab assignment. You will have the flexibility to review the slides and watch the lecture video at your own pace during the week.

Live Course Overview Session: (Optional)

This overview session is scheduled for **Tuesday, May 5th from 3 pm to 3 pm.**

You can attend this live introductory session by using the zoom link that will be posted on the avenue.

Weekly Office hours through zoom, every Tuesday from 3 pm to 4 pm

Important Links

- [Mosaic](#)
- [Avenue to Learn](#)
- [Student Accessibility Services - Accommodations](#)
- [McMaster University Library](#)

Course Learning Goals

At the end of this course, students are expected to

- Understand how to use mathematical models to understand macroeconomic issues.
- Understand how individual households make leisure, consumption and savings decisions to maximize their welfare.
- Understand how firms make hiring and investment decisions to maximize profits.
- Understand how the joint behaviour of firms and households determines aggregate outcomes.
- Understand the forces/shocks driving business cycles.

Materials and Fees

Required: E-textbook *Macroeconomics*, Seventh Canadian Edition, with MyLab.

ISBN: 9 780 138 245 184

Authors: Stephen D. Williamson

Publisher: Pearson

Edition: Seventh Canadian Edition

Textbook Listing at Campus Store: <https://campusstore.mcmaster.ca/Course/campus>

Price: \$104.95

Notes about course materials:

- Course Materials will be available through the Campus Store **Immediate Access (IA) program**, providing access to the textbook and MyLab through Avenue to Learn

Course Evaluation Details

1. MyLab Quizzes = 20% (best 5 out of 7, 4% each)
2. 2 Term Tests = 30% (15% percent each)
3. Final Exam (cumulative) = 50%

MyLab Quizzes

These quizzes will be administered through MyLab. They will be submitted using the publisher's website. Through the *Immediate Access* program, access to this website and the textbook is automatic with registration on A2L. Do not purchase directly from the publisher's website, or another website, as your access may not be guaranteed. There are a total of seven MyLab quizzes (MLQ). Their due dates are included in the course schedule below. Here is the *tentative* coverage of the MyLab quizzes:

MLQ 1: chapters 1 & 2
MLQ 2: chapters 3 and part of 4
MLQ 3: chapter 4
MLQ 4: chapter 5
MLQ 5: part of chapter 9
MLQ 6: chapter 9
MLQ 7: chapter 11

Term Tests

Both term tests will be online through A2L on the following dates:

Test # 1 (60 minutes) Thursday, May 21st, from 130 pm to 230 pm [available on the A2L]

Test # 2(60 minutes) Thursday, June 4th, from 130 pm to 230 pm [available on the A2L]

Final Exam

The final exam will take place in person on Tuesday, June 23, from 1:00 p.m. –3:30 p.m. at McMaster. A limited off-campus option may be approved by the department; all [application](#) materials and requirements must be submitted by Friday, April 27, 2026, or the exam must be written on campus. For full details, please review the [Guidelines for Off Campus Final Examination](#).

Method of Evaluation

Method of evaluation for quizzes, term tests and the final exam: short-answer questions, numerical calculations, mathematical derivations, true-false, multiple-choice, and fill-in-the-blank questions.

Grading Scale

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Grade	Equivalent Grade Point	Equivalent Percentages
A+	12	90-100
A	11	85-89
A-	10	80-84
B+	9	77-79
B	8	73-76
B-	7	70-72
C+	6	67-69
C	5	63-66
C-	4	60-62
D+	3	57-59
D	2	53-56
D-	1	50-52
F	0	0-49

Course Schedule

The course will closely follow the required e-textbook. The tentative outline is as follows:

Part I: Introduction and Measurement Issues

- Introduction (Chapter 1)
- Measurement Issues (Chapters 2 and 3)

Part II: Basic Macroeconomic Models

- Consumer and Firm Behaviour: The Work-Leisure Decision and Profit Maximization (Chapter 4)
- A Closed-Economy One-Period Macroeconomic Model (Chapter 5)

Part III: Savings, Investment, and Government Deficits

- A Two-Period Model: The Consumption-Savings Decision and Credit Markets (Chapter 9)
- A Real Intertemporal Model with Investment (Chapter 11)

Week	Dates	Content	Assessment
1	Module 1 May 4 th to May 8 th	Intro to the course and organization Ch. 1-Introduction Ch. 2-Measurement	MLQ #1 due
2	Module 2 May 11 th to May 15 th	Ch. 3-Business cycle measurement Ch. 4: Consumer theory	MLQ #2 due
3	Module 3 May 18 th to May 22 nd	Ch. 4: Consumer theory (continued) Test-1 (May 21) [chapters 1 to 4]	MLQ #3 due
4	Module 4 May 25 th to May 29 th	Ch. 5: A Closed-Economy One-Period model	MLQ #4 due
5	Module 5 June 1 st to June 5 th	Ch. 9: A Two-Period Model Test-2 (June 4) [chapters 5 & 9]	MLQ #5 due
6	Week 6 June 8 th to June 12 th	Ch 11: A Real Intertemporal Model with Investment (RIMI)	MLQ #6 due
7	Week 7 June 15 th to June 19 th	Ch 11: RIMI	MLQ #7 due

Important Dates

Last day withdrawing from courses without failure by default: Monday, June 1
 Test # 1 (60 minutes) Thursday, May 21st, from 130 pm to 230 pm [available on the A2L]
 Test # 2(60 minutes) Thursday, June 4th, from 130 pm to 230 pm [available on the A2L]
 Final Exam (in-person) Tuesday, June 23rd from 1 pm to 330 pm

Absences, Missed Work or Illness

Since the two quizzes with the lowest scores will be dropped, **MSAF will not be accepted for the MyLab quizzes.**

If you miss a test, you must submit an MSAF to be granted relief. Please note the following regarding the McMaster MSAF policy:

- Students must submit their MSAF (Self-Report) within one (1) calendar day of the end of the three (3) calendar day period, and failure to do so may negate the opportunity for relief.
- Students must contact their instructor(s) no later than one (1) calendar day after submitting the request unless the course outline states otherwise. Failure to do so may negate the opportunity for relief.

If you submit a valid MSAF and meet the deadlines stated above, the weight of the test will be applied to the final exam according.

Turnitin.com

Some courses may use a web-based service (Turnitin.com) to reveal authenticity and ownership of student submitted work. For students using such software, students will be expected to submit their work electronically either directly to Turnitin.com or via an online learning platform (e.g. A2L, etc.) using plagiarism detection (a service supported by Turnitin.com) so it can be checked for academic dishonesty.

Students who do not wish their work to be submitted through the plagiarism detection software must inform the Instructor before the assignment is due. No penalty will be assigned to a student who does not submit work to the plagiarism detection software. All submitted work is subject to normal verification that standards of academic integrity have been upheld (e.g., on-line search, other software, etc.). For more details about McMaster's use of Turnitin.com please go to www.mcmaster.ca/academicintegrity.

Course Modification

The instructor and university reserve the right to modify elements of the course during the term. The university may change the dates and deadlines for any or all courses in extreme circumstances. If either type of modification becomes necessary, reasonable notice and communication with the students will be given with an explanation and the opportunity to comment on changes. It is the responsibility of the student to check their McMaster email and course websites weekly during the term and to note any changes.

Generative AI

Generative AI: Use Prohibited

Students are not permitted to use generative AI in this course. In alignment with [McMaster academic integrity policy](#), it "shall be an offence knowingly to ... submit academic work for assessment that was purchased or acquired from another source". This includes work created by generative AI tools. Also state in the policy is the following, "Contract Cheating is the act of "outsourcing of student work to third parties" (Lancaster & Clarke, 2016, p. 639) with or without payment." Using Generative AI tools is a form of contract cheating. Charges of academic dishonesty will be brought forward to the Office of Academic Integrity.

APPROVED ADVISORY STATEMENTS

Academic Integrity

You are expected to exhibit honesty and use ethical behaviour in all aspects of the learning process. Academic credentials you earn are rooted in principles of honesty and academic integrity. **It is your responsibility to understand what constitutes academic dishonesty.**

Academic dishonesty is to knowingly act or fail to act in a way that results or could result in unearned academic credit or advantage. This behaviour can result in serious consequences, e.g. the grade of zero on an assignment, loss of credit with a notation on the transcript (notation reads: “Grade of F assigned for academic dishonesty”), and/or suspension or expulsion from the university. For information on the various types of academic dishonesty please refer to the [Academic Integrity Policy](https://secretariat.mcmaster.ca/university-policies-proceduresguidelines/), located at <https://secretariat.mcmaster.ca/university-policies-proceduresguidelines/>

The following illustrates only three forms of academic dishonesty:

- plagiarism, e.g. the submission of work that is not one’s own or for which other credit has been obtained.
- improper collaboration in group work.
- copying or using unauthorized aids in tests and examinations.

Authenticity / Plagiarism

Some courses may use a web-based service (Turnitin.com) to reveal authenticity and ownership of student submitted work. For courses using such software, students will be expected to submit their work electronically either directly to Turnitin.com or via an online learning platform (e.g. Avenue to Learn, etc.) using plagiarism detection (a service supported by Turnitin.com) so it can be checked for academic dishonesty.

Students who do not wish their work to be submitted through the plagiarism detection software must inform the Instructor before the assignment is due. No penalty will be assigned to a student who does not submit work to the plagiarism detection software. **All submitted work is subject to normal verification that standards of academic integrity have been upheld** (e.g., on-line search, other software, etc.). For more details about McMaster’s use of Turnitin.com please go to www.mcmaster.ca/academicintegrity.

Email Communication

Effective September 1, 2010, it is the policy of the Faculty of Social Sciences that all e-mail communication sent from students to instructors (including Tasks), and from students to staff, must originate from the student's own McMaster University e-mail account. This policy protects confidentiality and confirms the identity of the student. It is the student's responsibility to ensure that communication is sent to the university from a McMaster account. If an instructor becomes aware that a communication has come from an alternate address, the instructor may not reply at his/her/their discretion.

Courses with an On-line Element

Some courses may use on-line elements (e.g. e-mail, Avenue to Learn, LearnLink, web pages, capa, Moodle, ThinkingCap, etc.). Students should be aware that, when they access the electronic components of a course using these elements, private information such as first and last names, usernames for the McMaster e-mail accounts, and program affiliation may become apparent to all other students in the same course. The available information is dependent on the technology used. Continuation in a course that uses on-line elements will be deemed consent to this disclosure. If you have any questions or concerns about such disclosure, please discuss this with the course instructor.

Online Proctoring

Some courses may use online proctoring software for tests and exams. This software may require students to turn on their video camera, present identification, monitor and record their computer activities, and/or lock/restrict their browser or other applications/software during tests or exams. This software may be required to be installed before the test/exam begins.

Conduct Expectations

As a McMaster student, you have the right to experience, and the responsibility to demonstrate, respectful and dignified interactions within all of our living, learning and working communities. These expectations are described in the [Code of Student Rights & Responsibilities](#) (the “Code”). All students share the responsibility of maintaining a positive environment for the academic and personal growth of all McMaster community members, **whether in person or online.**

It is essential that students be mindful of their interactions online, as the Code remains in effect in virtual learning environments. The Code applies to any interactions that adversely affect, disrupt, or interfere with reasonable participation in University activities. Student disruptions or behaviours that interfere with university functions on online platforms (e.g. use of Avenue 2 Learn, WebEx or Zoom for delivery), will be taken very seriously and will be investigated. Outcomes may include restriction or removal of the involved students’ access to these platforms.

Academic Accommodation of Students with Disabilities

Students with disabilities who require academic accommodation must contact [Student Accessibility Services](#) (SAS) at 905-525-9140 ext. 28 652 or sas@mcmaster.ca to make arrangements with a Program Coordinator. For further information, consult McMaster University’s [Academic Accommodation of Students with Disabilities](#) policy.

Requests for Relief for Missed Academic Term Work

In the event of an absence for medical or other reasons, students should review and follow the [Policy on Requests for Relief for Missed Academic Term Work](#).

Academic Accommodation for Religious, Indigenous, or Spiritual Observances (RISO)

Students requiring academic accommodation based on religious, indigenous or spiritual observances should follow the procedures set out in the [RISO](#) policy. Students should submit their request to their Faculty Office ***normally within 10 working days*** of the beginning of term in which they anticipate a need for accommodation or to the Registrar's Office prior to their examinations. Students should also contact their instructors as soon as possible to make alternative arrangements for classes, assignments, and tests.

Copyright and Recording

Students are advised that lectures, demonstrations, performances, and any other course material provided by an instructor include copyright protected works. The Copyright Act and copyright law protect every original literary, dramatic, musical and artistic work, **including lectures** by University instructors.

The recording of lectures, tutorials, or other methods of instruction may occur during a course. Recording may be done by either the instructor for the purpose of authorized distribution, or by a student for the purpose of personal study. Students should be aware that their voice and/or image may be recorded by others during the class. Please speak with the instructor if this is a concern for you.

Extreme Circumstances

The University reserves the right to change the dates and deadlines for any or all courses in extreme circumstances (e.g., severe weather, labour disruptions, etc.). Changes will be communicated through regular McMaster communication channels, such as McMaster Daily News, Avenue to Learn and/or McMaster email.